

Trak Character - Content Rulebook

Rules for writing scenarios, flashcards and reflection prompts

Rules for anyone writing scenarios, flashcards or reflection prompts. Derived from the review by Maria Psychountaki, sports psychologist. Follow these without needing the theory behind them – the reasoning is noted where it helps.

The four rules that override everything

- 1. **Never identify the child with the mistake.** Address the action, never the person. **"That reaction cost the team"** – never **"you are hot-headed."** Her words: handled this way a mistake becomes **"a lesson and not a trauma."** She confirmed there is no psychological risk in scenarios about failure, conflict or losing **provided this rule holds.**
- 2. **Never grade, score or rank character.** Confirmed as correct. Progress is shown as values demonstrated and season progress – never a number, never one child against another.
- 3. **Do not increase screen time.** The strongest warning in her review, raised twice unprompted. The programme must not **"reinforce addiction to electronic media."** Design target: **a few minutes, 2-3 times a week, or once at the end of the week.** Never daily, never continuous.
- 4. **Reflection must be guided, never open-ended.** **"It is essential to have questions that substantially guide the child through their reflection."** Never ship a blank box. Always ask something specific.

Rhythm

- **One value per week** – confirmed as **"a very good rhythm."**
- Within that week: **many different scenarios and instructions** for applying the value.
- **Repetition across the season** is expected, not a failure of imagination.
- Engagement is capped by rule 3 above. If a design increases how often a child opens the app, it is wrong regardless of how well it performs.

Volume – the hard requirement

Multiple scenarios per value per age band. This is not optional and not about variety.

Her answer on gaming the system: social desirability **"cannot be avoided"** in any self-report process. The only mitigation is **many different scenarios for the same value**, so that a child who exaggerates in one is caught by inconsistency across others.

So scenario volume does two jobs at once – teaching, and making self-report readable. Thin content breaks both.

Age bands

Confirmed as sound. **"It is important that the scenarios correspond to each level."**

Band	Scenario style
~6-9	Concrete, rule- and authority-based. Short. One idea per scenario

~10-13	Fairness, intent and consequences. Choices with a defensible answer
~14-18	Abstract, identity, leadership, competing goods. No clean answer required

Watch for over-confidence in the youngest band. "Young children tend to overestimate their abilities." Their self-ratings should be treated as a conversation starter, not a measurement.

Two anchors, and they are not interchangeable — a correction from her review: - Kohlberg → moral development. Use for how a child reasons about right and wrong. - Piaget → cognitive development. Use for what a child can process at all.

Optionally frame content against the developmental domains: cognitive, physical, social, personality.

The values

Confirmed: Composure • Respect • Effort • Teamwork • Responsibility • Sportsmanship

Proposed additions, for a product decision — the last two are notably sport-specific and have no current equivalent:

Candidate	Note
Discipline	
Cooperation	Overlaps with Teamwork — probably merge rather than add
Managing winning and losing	No current equivalent. Strong candidate
Resilience to criticism	No current equivalent. Strong candidate

The "act" step

Validated: "the 'do' is needed because it reinforces learning."

But it must carry proper instructions. A real-world challenge cannot be a vague nudge — it needs to say plainly what to do, when, and what counts as having done it.

What we may claim

Her wording, and the ceiling on our claims:

Children **get to know themselves better** and are **more ready to choose what is right**.

Not behaviour change. Not measurable character improvement. Not fewer incidents. Self-knowledge and readiness — that is the honest claim and it came from the expert.

Mandatory, non-negotiable

Parental consent. Her emphasis, in capitals: since every age band is minors, consent is "**MANDATORY**." This is now a stated professional requirement for the lawyer conversation, not an assumption of ours.

Checklist before any scenario ships

- ☐ Addresses the action, never the child's character
- ☐ Matched to the age band's reasoning level
- ☐ Part of a set of several scenarios for that value, not a one-off
- ☐ Any reflection attached to it asks a specific, guiding question
- ☐ Any "act" step states exactly what to do and what counts as done
- ☐ Adds no pressure to open the app more often
- ☐ Contains no score, rank or comparison to another child

Open, for the product decision

1. Adopt "Managing winning and losing" and "Resilience to criticism" as values?
2. What replaces streaks as the reason to come back, given rule 3?
3. How much character detail does the coach see, given she called per-athlete monitoring a "**huge burden**"?